a. Knits

Knits are an important part of every wardrobe because they are comfortable to wear and easy to care. Because of their elasticity, knit garments do not require a lot of fitting and they shed wrinkles well. Most knits do not ravel, making them quick and easy to sew. Knits are versatile and can be seen in everything from the most casual wear to the formal clothing attire. They come in a variety of fabrics that vary in textures, elasticity, fibre content, weight and design.

Points to be considered before preparing knitted fabric :

- Washable knits tend to shrink more often and to a greater degree than woven fabric.
- Always purchase extra yardage to allow for shrinkage. For best results wash and dry the fabric before cutting.
- Washing also helps to relax the fabric and remove the fabric sizing.
- Excess sizing can cause skipped machine stitches, pre shrink firm, interfacing, lining and garment.
- Generally, rib knit net should not be prewashed. Washing softens it and makes it difficult to cut accurately.

b. Silk Fabrics

Silk is a luxurious and sensuous fabric that has been coveted for centuries. Silk, which originates from the cocoons of silkworms, is also the strongest natural fibre. The slippery and smooth texture of this fabric poses some difficulties that require special care when sewing. There are simple techniques to make silk easier to handle and sew for every stage of a handmade sewing project.

Washing

Wash your silk in warm (hot) water using a special washing detergent for delicates.

Hand Washing

Hand washing is preferred but machine washing on delicate cycle is also acceptable. Many silk pursuits claim that the best thing to wash silk is shampoo. While washing silk, rub, twist bringing or scrunching. Rinse should be done fabric several times in cold water. If silk is rinsed in vinegar solution the colours will look brighter and the surface will look brighter and shine.

Drying

Silk fabric should be dried away from direct sun or heaters. Silk fabric should not be over dried or pressed. Wrap the silk in a damp cloth and put it in a plastic bag for a couple of hours. This should evenly "moisturize" fabric and then press it. Silk, must be pressed with dry iron, because steam might cause it to wrinkle.

Pressing and Inspecting

The ironing should not be too hot or it should not have snag on the sole of it. Use a sheet of baking paper to protect the fabric. If the silk has some stretch, it is best to press it through another layer of fabric such as cotton and silk.

Rayon has been around for many years and the processes used to create it were pioneering in the early manufacture of materials. It is an integral part of the fabrics for nowadays, Rayon is a fibre and not a completely natural product because it undergoes several chemical processes. However, it is extracted from the cellulose

XII TDD_English version CHAPTER 08.indd 113 1/13/2020 3:18:47 PM